

SHOWCASE

Haupt rotary mobile phone

Chances are today's generation has no idea what a rotary phone is, and probably have never seen a phone with a rotary dial in the entire span of their lives. That makes this particular mobile phone all the more interesting. Designed by Justine Haupt, what we have here is a rotary mobile phone, which looks like a concept of what today's mobile phones might have been, five decades ago.



Built utilising modern day materials and tech, the phone is definitely more compact than rotary phones from back in the day. It also uses modern chipsets and uses a custom board on the inside,

all of which has been fitted inside a 3D-printed case. Even though it's more compact than traditional rotary phones, this one isn't going to fit in your pocket. Unless you've got huge pockets. However, you would still use this phone like you would a smartphone, by holding it up to your ear. It's also got a 10-LED signal meter, programmable shortcut contacts, a power switch and a curved e-ink screen which displays missed calls and the like. The design is open source for those who want to build their own.



MIT machine-washable wearable

A team of researchers at MIT have come up with a wearable that can be sewn into clothing. This wearable can then monitor the wearer's vitals. The sensor, in addition to being incredibly lightweight, is also machine-washable. The sensor can be integrated into a number of different types of fabrics as well.

The use-cases for such a wearable are pretty varied. From being integrated into T-shirts of people playing sports, to the obvious use in healthcare to monitor vitals. Like we mentioned earlier, the sensor is incredibly lightweight and it's also thin, and nicely embeds itself into the folds of fabric. So it shouldn't hinder the wearer while at the same time monitoring things like heart rate, body temp, and respiratory rate.

The sensor can also be easily removed from one fabric and used with another. The added benefit of not having to worry about damaging it if you accidentally put it into the washing machine is a plus. Part of this particular project was funded by NASA, so it's likely that it will see use by NASA as well, possibly.

Garmin Vector 3 smart pedal

You might be wondering, what exactly is the point of smart pedals? Smart cycle, okay, maybe that we get, but why smart pedals? There's plenty of reasons apparently.

Starting things off, these pedals are extremely lightweight, with both pedals weighing a combined total of 3.16kg. Of course, that is still heavier than conventional pedals, but it's still impressive considering the tech that's packed inside.

The Garmin Vector 3 can measure the amount of power you put into pedalling, which is actually more important than say your average speed, or other external factors.

By measuring the power of your pedalling, you're getting consistent feedback on your performance.



Additionally, the Vector 3 will show you which of your legs you use with more power, where exactly on the pedals you apply more pressure, and how or what you can adjust to improve your cycling dynamic. This includes fixing your seating/standing position while cycling, showing which areas of the pedal you apply more pressure to, and degrees and which you pedal and where your peak power lies. It helps enthusiasts take cycling to the next level.

The Garmin Vector 3 smart pedal also integrates with any Garmin device you might already have, we're talking fitness tracker here, and will nicely show you a bunch of statistics. However, you'll miss out on a lot of the features if you don't have an accompanying Garmin device, so be wary of that.